

Forkcast — Store Readiness Checklist (Google Play first, then App Store)

Companion to [MOBILE_HANDOFF.md](#). That doc covers building the app; this one covers everything the stores require beyond the build. Items marked **(app change)** need code; items marked **(founders)** are the founders' (Seymour & Rahman) to produce; the rest is the developer's release work.

Forkcast collects health data (weight, height, conditions, allergies, meal logs), which puts it in the stricter review lane on both stores. Plan for that from day one, not at submission.

A. Required before EITHER store

1. **Hosted privacy policy URL (founders + app change)** — mandatory for both stores; must name every data type collected (health profile, meal logs, weight history, photos, location), why, where it's stored (Supabase), retention, and deletion. Add a `/privacy` page to the web app so the URL is on your own domain. I can draft this.
2. **Terms of service URL (founders)** — expected by reviewers for apps with subscriptions.
3. **In-app account deletion (app change)** — both stores require that users can delete their account and data from inside the app. Backend needs a `delete_user_data()` flow (Supabase: delete auth user; rows cascade via the FKs already in the migration). Put it in Profile → Membership.
4. **In-app purchases for Premium (app change)** — \$4.99/mo · \$39.99/yr must go through Play Billing / StoreKit (RevenueCat wraps both). Selling the subscription any other way inside the app is a rejection on both stores. Free 7-day trial maps to a standard introductory offer.
5. **Health disclaimers surfaced in-app** — the “not medical advice” language the web app already uses must appear on the coach chat, condition warnings, and onboarding. Reviewers look for it.
6. **Assets** — adaptive icon (Android) / app icon set (iOS), splash screen, feature graphic (Play), 6–8 screenshots per form factor, short + full description. Design tokens in the handoff; I can generate first drafts.
7. **Location permission rationale** — Discover uses geolocation; both stores require a plain-language purpose string, and Android 12+ needs the approximate/precise choice handled.
8. **Camera/photo permission rationale** — for photo meal logging.

B. Google Play (first release)

1. **Developer account (founders)** — one-time \$25, plus D-U-N-S/identity verification for organization accounts (allow ~1 week).
2. **Data Safety form** — must exactly match the privacy policy and actual SDK behavior (Supabase, AI endpoints). Health data → declare “Health & fitness” data types, encrypted in transit, deletable on request.
3. **Health apps declaration** — Play requires an additional declaration for apps handling health data; complete it in Play Console → App content.
4. **Testing gates** — new personal accounts need a closed test with 12 testers for 14 days before production. Plan the pilot cohort as those testers.
5. **Signing** — Play App Signing (default), target API level current per Play policy; Expo/EAS handles both.

C. App Store (second release)

1. **Apple Developer Program (founders)** — \$99/yr; enroll early, identity verification can take days.
2. **Privacy nutrition labels** — App Store Connect questionnaire mirroring the Data Safety form.
3. **Sign in with Apple (app change)** — required IF any third-party/social login is offered. Email/password-only (current plan) does NOT trigger it; adding Google sign-in later would.

4. **Guideline 5.1.3 (health data)** — health data may not be used for advertising; do not add ad SDKs. State this in the policy.
5. **Review demo account** — provide a seeded demo login + notes explaining the “prototype integration” order labeling so the reviewer doesn’t flag a “non-functional” checkout. The honesty labels the product already carries are an asset here.
6. **TestFlight** — external testing needs its own lightweight review; use it for the pilot cohort on iOS.

D. Sequencing note (one codebase, two launches)

Expo/EAS builds both stores from the same code. “Android first” is a release order, not a separate project: ship Play closed test → production, then the identical app to TestFlight → App Store, reusing all metadata and the privacy answers. If the developer instead proposes a native Kotlin Android app now and a separate iOS app later, surface it immediately — it forfeits the shared TypeScript core (`lib/nutrition.ts` etc.), doubles long-term cost, and both apps must then be verified against the web app’s numbers by hand.

E. Founders’ to-do summary

- ☐ Play developer account + Apple Developer Program enrollment
- ☐ Privacy policy + ToS drafted and hosted (ask me — I’ll draft both and add `/privacy` and `/terms` pages to the web app)
- ☐ Decide subscription platform (RevenueCat recommended) and create the products (monthly \$4.99, annual \$39.99, 7-day intro trial)
- ☐ Pilot cohort 12 people for the Play closed-test requirement
- ☐ Demo reviewer account with seeded data